



Rating
Buy

North America
United States

Consumer
Autos & Auto Technology

Company
Tesla Inc.

Reuters
TSLA.OQ

Bloomberg
TSLA US

Exchange
NMS

Ticker
TSLA

Date
27 July 2026

Forecast Change

Price at 24 Jul 2026 (USD)	313.03
Price target	420.00
52-week range	489.88 - 21.00

Robotaxi, Optimus, and SpaceX

Following earnings (see our First Look [here](#)), we think it's fairly clear Robotaxi and especially Optimus (supply chain) are scaling slower than anticipated which is disappointing the market. Moreover, the sentiment towards physical or embodied AI has tapered down and the prospect of a SpaceX merger has likely added another element of volatility. Overall, we suspect we're entering a tricky period of time where Tesla may not demonstrate any significant milestones until late in the year while cash burn increases materially. We maintain our Buy rating but lower our price target to \$420.

Robotaxi awaits V15 and Cybercab calibration

Tesla's unsupervised Robotaxi fleet has logged >380k miles with zero notable incidents. Cumulative paid miles reached ~2.5 million by end of 2Q26. The service is live in seven US markets: geofence expansion in Austin plus commercial launches in Miami, Orlando, and Tampa with preparations underway for Phoenix and Las Vegas (Bay Area remains safety-monitor only). Unsupervised miles have grown at a double-digit week-over-week rate. The binding constraint appears to be the "march of the nines" – driving extreme reliability by clearing the long tail of rare edge cases so notable incidents stay extraordinarily unlikely. V14 software was a large step up, but we suspect it still falls short of the desired safety threshold; V15 (model has ~10x more parameters, on the order of 10bn) is meant to close that gap. The Robotaxi fleet is already on early V15 builds, underpinned by seven major improvement tracks over V14, with ~40% already merged.

Separately, Cybercab's unique design creates a domain-shift issue. The system has been trained mainly on existing Tesla vehicles especially Model Y, so a smaller two-seater with different geometry, dynamics, and camera mounts may not transfer perfectly. Camera views, interaction with other road users, and control outputs still need chassis-specific validation. Tesla is accumulating miles via engineering test vehicles (some still with controls) and employee autonomous rides at Gigafactory Texas, and has matched Cybercab manufacturing targets to the projected growth of unsupervised miles. Once that validation is in hand, unsupervised Cybercab deployment can accelerate.

Optimus still faces supply-chain constraints

Optimus production remains in the early stages and constrained by parts of the supply chain. Initial builds at Fremont which should start production "soon" will go

Valuation & Risks

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Key changes			
TP	465.00 to 420.00	↓	-9.7%
EPS (USD)	1.58 to 1.50	↓	-4.9%
Revenue (USDm)	105,167.7 to 108,175.3	↑	2.9%
Source: Deutsche Bank			

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only to the internal “Optimus Academy” for training data and further development. The primary bottleneck is product novelty. Roughly 10,000 unique parts must be sourced or built in-house and Tesla is attempting to stand up parts of the supply base literally from scratch (i.e., much more so than with BEVs early on). While Optimus V3 is sourcing certain components from Chinese suppliers (Hengli, Rongtai, etc...), we suspect there may be bottlenecks in other areas where management aims to bring in-house. For example, management indicated for the future Optimus V4, the plan is to in-source the PCB.

Figure 1: Optimus first generation production line in Fremont



Source : Company reports

Contemplating SpaceX merger

Our sense after speaking with investors post the SpaceX [initiation](#) is that a Tesla combination is highly likely to occur: the question is mainly timing. According to Kalshi as of yesterday, the likelihood of a merger happening before 2028 is 68%. While we had thought the main strategic merits would mostly revolve around chips and humanoids, we see another area of synergy emerging on the Starlink side. Tesla has recently begun installing Starlink broadband antennas on its Cybercabs to enhance connectivity. Looking ahead, we wonder if it can somehow leverage its existing large user base of consumer antenna dishes and eventually robotaxis in the future to support its Starlink Mobile efforts.

Now if most investors believe SpaceX will acquire Tesla at some point, does that mean the stock could have a floor at some level? Looking back, recall Elon Musk had previously indicated a deal was being considered at \$420 back in 2018 and he later acquired Twitter at \$54.20 per share in 2022 (sensing a pattern perhaps?). At the same time though, the recent weakness in SpaceX’s stock naturally makes it harder to facilitate a deal.

Overall, we update our forecasts and lower our price target by \$45 to \$420, adjusting the multiples in our SOTP (see Figures 2 and 3); maintain Buy rating.

Risk: Tesla faces a variety of risks given its broad reach. On automotive, we believe the largest risk is demand softness/stagnation related to EV fatigue and/or competition. For energy storage, the main end-market is B2B and competition is generally less intense than auto for now. For mobility and robotics, there is execution risk given a lot of data still needs to be collected and investment is required (e.g., new supply-chain



build-up, chip availability) to achieve widespread commercialization. Moreover, there is regulatory risk as the governing bodies may choose to scrutinize real-world deployments of end-to-end AI. Unique to Tesla, we would also identify leadership risk considering Elon Musk's importance to the valuation of the company.

Figure 2: Valuation framework (NEW)

	Revenue (\$bn)	EBITDA	Multiple (x)	Enterprise value	Present value	Per share	Assumptions
Auto (2030E)	\$85		6.0	504	345	\$99	>2m unit sales
Energy (2030E)	\$38	\$11	15.0	169	116	\$33	170 GWh storage deployed
FSD (2030E)	\$10		22.5	225	154	\$44	subscription + licensing
Humanoid robot (2035E)	\$31		27.5	859	365	\$105	1.25m robots @ \$25k per unit
Robotaxi (2035E)	\$45		25.0	1,125	478	\$137	~2.0m vehicle fleet
Services/other (2030E)	\$23		0.5	11	8	\$2	accessories, F&I, used car sales
Total					1,464	\$420	

Source : Company reports, Deutsche Bank Research

Figure 3: Valuation framework (OLD)

	Revenue (\$bn)	EBITDA	Multiple (x)	Enterprise value	Present value	Per share	Assumptions
Auto (2030E)	\$84		6.0	505	347	\$99	>2m unit sales
Energy (2030E)	\$39	\$12	15.0	174	120	\$34	170 GWh storage deployed
FSD (2030E)	\$10		26.0	260	179	\$51	subscription + licensing
Humanoid robot (2035E)	\$31		30.0	938	404	\$116	1.25m robots @ \$25k per unit
Robotaxi (2035E)	\$45		29.3	1,316	567	\$162	~2.0m vehicle fleet
Services/other (2030E)	\$22		0.5	11	7	\$2	accessories, F&I, used car sales
Total					1,625	\$465	

Source : Company reports, Deutsche Bank Research

Figure 4: Estimate changes

	Prior			Revised		
	2025	2026E	2027E	2025	2026E	2027E
Deliveries	1,636,129	1,770,088	1,821,024	1,636,129	1,839,492	1,893,096
Revenue (\$m)	94,827	105,168	110,015	94,827	108,175	113,140
Automotive	69,526	75,338	73,498	69,526	77,981	76,300
Energy/storage	12,771	14,197	18,834	12,771	13,793	18,312
Services & other	12,530	15,633	17,683	12,530	16,401	18,528
Auto GM (GAAP)	17.8%	19.0%	17.0%	17.8%	17.9%	16.9%
Auto GM (ex-credit)	15.4%	17.7%	16.1%	15.4%	16.8%	16.0%
EPS (non-GAAP)	\$1.66	\$1.58	\$1.30	\$1.66	\$1.50	\$1.43
Free cash flow	6,220	(12,437)	(14,600)	6,220	(12,215)	(14,833)

Source : Company Reports, Deutsche Bank Research



Appendix 1

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Tesla Inc.	TSLA.OQ	313.03 (USD) 24 Jul 2026	8, 14, 15, 21, 24

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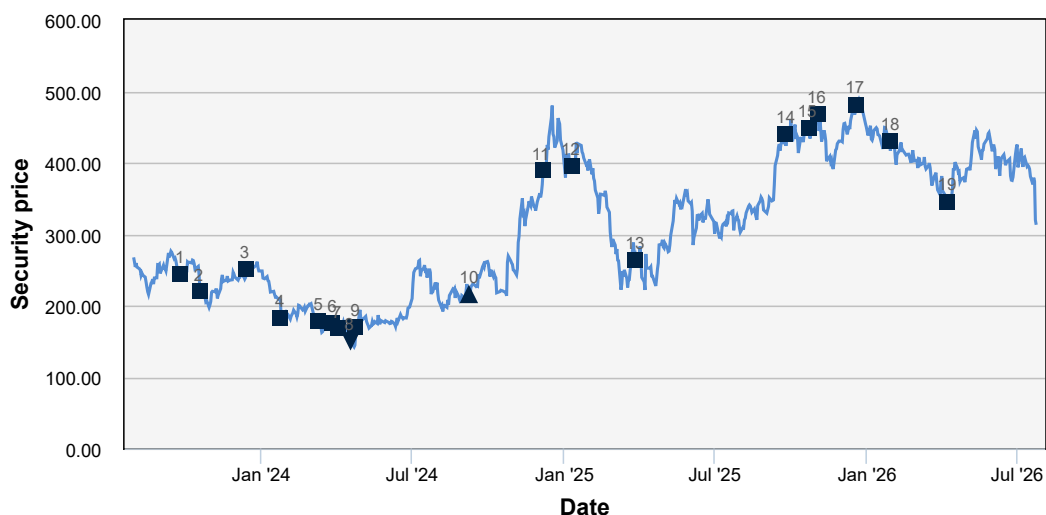
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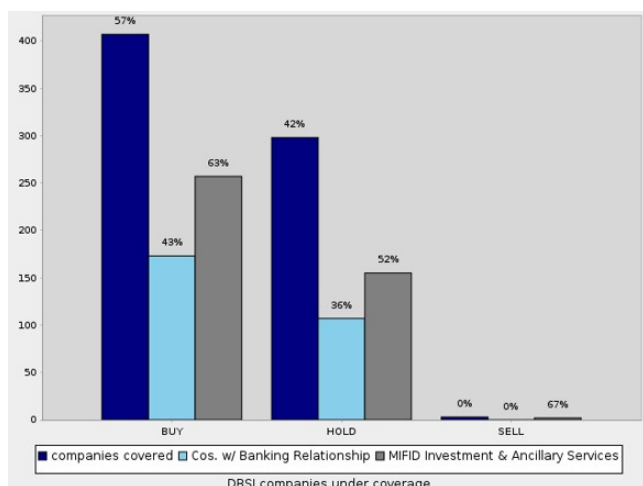
(as of 07/24/2026)



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2. 10/19/2023	Buy, Target Price Change USD 275.00, Current Price USD 220.11 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**	12. 01/10/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 420.00, Current Price USD 394.74 Edison Yu
3. 12/14/2023	Buy, Target Price Change USD 260.00, Current Price USD 251.05 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**	13. 03/28/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 345.00, Current Price USD 263.55 Edison Yu
4. 01/25/2024	Buy, Target Price Change USD 250.00, Current Price USD 182.63 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**	14. 09/26/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 435.00, Current Price USD 440.40 Edison Yu
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7. 04/03/2024	Buy, Target Price Change USD 189.00, Current Price USD 168.38 Emmanuel Rosner, CFA**	17. 12/19/2025	Buy, Target Price Change USD 500.00, Current Price USD 481.20 Edison Yu
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